



WE ARE OPEN

Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)—an ambitious initiative to bring about structural changes in the current platform-centric e-commerce model—was thrown open for public users in Bengaluru Urban district on September 30, 2022. At present, about 60 per cent of India's e-commerce market is controlled by two US-based platforms—Amazon and Walmart-owned Flipkart. ONDC, an interoperable and open platform, has already onboarded over 200 merchants across grocery and food and beverage segments, and is in the process of onboarding more buyer and seller-side apps as it expands to more cities.

—BINU PAUL

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BASIS POINTS
THE QUANTUM
BY WHICH THE
RESERVE BANK
OF INDIA HAS
RAISED KEY
INTEREST RATES
SINCE MAY THIS
YEAR, TAKING
THE REPO RATE
TO A THREE-
YEAR HIGH OF
5.9 PER CENT

IN E-RETAIL WE TRUST

E-COMMERCE OPPORTUNITIES FOR SMEs are growing under the 'new normal'. New research by FedEx Express has revealed that 83 per cent of Indian consumers have increased their purchases from e-commerce platforms in the past three years, and this is likely to continue. Per its research, 80 per cent of SMEs agree that consumer

buying behaviour has fundamentally changed due to Covid-19, and most of them believe that e-commerce will continue to boom. Acknowledging the importance of marketplaces, 58 per cent of SMEs sell directly to customers through e-commerce platforms, the research has found.

—NIDHI SINGAL

THWARTING THE INSIDER



The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) has enhanced the scope of insider trading regulations by bringing mutual fund (MF) units under the regulation's ambit. Coming three months after the watchdog's consultation paper on the issue, the move was triggered after instances of MF officials selling their units when they had inside information on issues at the fund house came to light. While there are restrictions on trading of shares based on unpublished price-sensitive information, there was no direct bar on selling mutual fund units till now.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



EXPO-SING NEW OPPORTUNITIES

With the objective of capturing the growing global market for medical devices, the Indian government is spearheading the first ever medical devices expo—India MedTech Expo 2022 (IMTE-22)—in association with the Indian medical devices industry. The three-day expo will start from December 9, 2022, at Pragati Maidan, New Delhi. Union Minister of Chemicals and Fertilisers Mansukh Mandaviya has said that the expo will provide a platform for global sector leaders to explore India's potential as a manufacturing hub, and an emerging global market.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

In the Slow Lane

IN THE FIRST six months (April-September) of the current financial year, 14 firms raised ₹35,456 crore through mainboard IPOs, according to Prime Database. The amount raised is 32 per cent lower than the ₹51,979 crore raised through 25 IPOs in the corresponding period of 2021-22. As much as 58 per cent of the amount, or ₹20,557 crore, was raised by LIC alone earlier this year. It was followed by Delhivery (₹5,235 crore) and Rainbow Children's (₹1,581 crore). Pranav Haldea, MD of Prime Database, believes that going ahead, IPO activity will be impacted by the volatility in the secondary market, mainly because of recessionary fears in the US and rising interest rates across the world.

—RAHUL OBEROI